

CoinPicks Market Direction

Research Package

Five pillars — four researched narratives and one pure-math read of the Bitcoin chart — scored on one standard, blended into one table, and distilled to one number. Everything in this folder is current as of **September 17, 2026** — a light daily touch against yesterday's light daily touch (2026-09-16_draft, committed).

COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED (light daily touch, score set 2026-09-17_draft). CLARITY Act, Iran War Risk, and Tokenization RWA were re-checked and held flat — nothing found cleared the sufficiency bar. **Fed & Macro RE-RATED DOWN** (34/33/44/54/60 → 32/31/42/54/60) on the near/mid windows: the Sept 16 FOMC raised the federal funds target range 25bp to 3.75%-4.00% (largely priced, not scored alone), but its SEP/dot plot — a primary Fed document, not a market price — showed 16 of 18 officials expecting another 2026 hike, 12 of 18 pencilling in one more 25bp move by year-end. Ordinary light daily touch, full research access, verification clean — auto-stamped per the runbook's delegated authority.

THE FINAL NUMBER · SEPTEMBER 17, 2026 (COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED, LIGHT DAILY TOUCH, MERGE SET 2026-09-17_DRAFT2) · BTC \$76,440.74 ON SEPT 17

−0.13 Neutral — below zero, versus −0.05 on the cloud run's own Sept 17 set

Equal-weight mean of the five window signals below — every pillar counts 20% (scale −10 to +10). The headline reads −0.13 equal-weight; the horizon-weighted variant reads **+0.42**, versus +0.53, which flips *that* variant Mild Bull → Neutral. **Today is a MERGE cycle, and it is worth understanding before reading the number.** Two independent runs researched Sept 17: the cloud routine's, which committed and pushed first as 2026-09-17_draft, and a local run. This package is 2026-09-17_draft2, which takes the cloud's committed set as its baseline, carries its CLARITY Act, Iran War Risk and Tokenization values forward untouched, and corrects **one pillar only**: Fed & Macro, 32/31/42/54/60 → 32/30/38/44/58. Both runs agree the Sept 16 FOMC hiked 25bp to 3¾–4% on a 12–0 vote, that the hike was already priced and is therefore not the mover, and that the projections released with it are. They differ on how far out those projections reach — and that single disagreement is the whole gap between −0.05 and −0.13.

THE FIVE WINDOWS UNDERNEATH IT

WINDOW	MASTER SIGNAL	CALL
1 month	-2.13	Bear — identical in both Sept 17 sets: the near-term Fed drag is only the dot plot and a 10-year Treasury back at 5.0%, because the hike itself was already in the score. CLARITY (-4.76) and Iran (-4.70) dominate here
3 months	-1.79	Bear — a hair deeper than the baseline. Both remaining 2026 FOMC meetings sit inside this window, and a further 25bp is now the Committee’s own median expectation rather than a risk
6 months	-0.66	Mild Bear — Fed -1.02→-1.54 as the projections hold 4.1% straight through 2027, removing the pause-then-pivot this window was carrying
1 year	+1.10	Mild Bull — the one materially different window, and the reason this merge set exists. Fed crosses negative here (+0.48→-0.72) because the end-2027 median moving 3.6%→4.1% is precisely a fact about the one-year window. Tokenization (+3.00), CLARITY (+3.17) and Bitcoin TA (+1.82) still carry it
3 years	+2.81	Bull — barely moved, every pillar still positive. Deferring an easing cycle by a year does not reach three years out

Bands: |s| < 0.5 Neutral · < 1.5 Mild · < 3 Bull/Bear · < 5 Strong · else Very Strong. The leave-one-out range this cycle is -0.60 to +0.65 — the sign flips positive (Mild Bull) only when Iran War Risk is dropped (+0.65); **dropping Tokenization alone pushes the reading further negative to -0.60, Mild Bear.** See the Master Report's Robustness section.

Reading order

Twenty minutes to the whole picture; each report stands alone and can be checked independently — every fact is dated with sources on its last page.

#	FILE	WHAT IT IS
1	CoinPicks_Master_Direction_Report.pdf	The summary. The final number, the five-window table, the full pillar matrix, where the lenses agree/fight, six weeks of dated triggers, sensitivity.
2	CoinPicks_Bitcoin_TA_Quant_Pillar_Report.pdf	The math pillar. 7 indicators on 16 years of data, halving-cycle analogs, power-law valuation — with charts. Fully reproducible from code.
3	reports/current/pdf/ — the four pillar PDFs	The story pillars. CLARITY Act · Iran War Risk · Tokenization RWA · Fed & Macro. Each: thesis, dated facts, honest bear case, dated triggers, and the full score lineage (June committed → ... → Sept 15 committed, light daily → Sept 16 committed, light daily → Sept 17 committed, light daily, this version).
4	reports/archive/ + prior-work/	Every earlier version, preserved untouched — the score history is fully auditable.
—	run.py · engine/blend.py · data/master_blend.json	The blend engine (runnable Python — reproduce any score set with <code>run.py blend --set NAME</code>), its output, and README.md for regeneration.

How the scoring works — one paragraph

Every pillar answers the same question on five windows (1 month / 3 months / 6 months / 1 year / 3 years): **P** = the odds (0–100) that this force is *good for crypto* by then, **Quality** = how trustworthy the evidence is (0–1), and **Impact** = how hard this force moves the whole market (0–10). These combine into a **Signal = ((P – 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact** (Impact is a uniform 8 for every pillar), so a coin-flip view scores zero no matter how loud the headlines are, and weak evidence can't shout. **All five pillars are equal-weighted** — the master for each window is the simple mean of the five signals (20% each; add a pillar and it auto-rebalances to 1/N) — and the Final Number averages the five master windows.

The five pillars at a glance (September 17 P's — MERGE SET 2026-09-17_draft2, Fed & Macro re-rated **DOWN**; COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED)

PILLAR	1MO	3MO	6MO	1YR	3YR	ONE-LINE READ
CLARITY Act (law)	15	28	45	72	92	Held flat: no new dated development since the Sept 15 cloture-vote failure; lame-duck speculation already priced
Iran War Risk	1	1	14	33	66	Held flat: no new development beyond the Sept 9 IAEA referral and the Sept 12-13 NPT statement already priced; Pezeshkian's no-nukes stance unchanged
Tokenization (RWA)	52	60	66	74	85	Held flat: Aave's Sept 16 RWA-hub announcement is single-product continuation, doesn't clear the bar
Fed & Macro	32	30	38	44	58	RE-RATED DOWN , and the only pillar this merge set changes from the cloud baseline (32/31/42/54/60). The FOMC hiked 12-0 to 3¾-4% — already priced since Warsh's Aug 28 Jackson Hole speech — but its projections moved the 2027 median fed funds rate from 3.6% to 4.1% , deleting a year of expected easing. That was not priced, and it is specifically a fact about the one-year window, so 12mo takes -10 and this pillar flips to Mild Bear there. Counterweight sized in: Chair Warsh filed <i>no dot at all</i> and said "I'm not in the forward guidance business"
Bitcoin TA (quant)	58	54	59	69	69	Recomputed on a full <i>local</i> quant refresh rather than a data relay (BTC \$76,440.74, Sept 17). Near term eased as the weekly composite slipped to +30.4 as-is (+31.3 on completed bars); the long end firmed as the cycle clock reached month 28.94. Notable: the tape absorbed a dead market-structure bill and a hawkish Fed without leaving its range

P values shown (50 = coin flip). CLARITY Act, Iran War Risk, and Tokenization held flat this cycle; Fed & Macro re-rated down, and this set (light daily touch, 2026-09-17_draft) is COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED.

Status & honesty notes

- **Score status — read this first, today is unusual.** Two independent runs researched Sept 17. The cloud routine committed and pushed its set first as 2026-09-17_draft; a local run researched the same day separately. This package is the merge, 2026-09-17_draft2, which takes the cloud's committed set as its *baseline* rather than overwriting it — that set is delivered, and lineage in this system is never rewritten. **Three pillars are carried forward from it untouched** (CLARITY Act 15/28/45/72/92, Iran War Risk 1/1/14/33/66, Tokenization 52/60/66/74/85), because they rest on dated facts the cloud run pulled and the local run did not independently surface. Correcting a pillar on better primary evidence is legitimate; reverting pillars because you did not look is not. **One pillar is corrected:** Fed & Macro, on the FOMC projections table. **AUTO-STAMPED** per the runbook's delegated daily authority.
- **The disagreement, in one paragraph, so you can judge it yourself.** Both runs read the Sept 16 FOMC the same way on the facts that matter most: a 25bp hike to 3¾–4% on a 12–0 vote, already priced and therefore not itself new information, with the Summary of Economic Projections as the real mover. The cloud run described the 2027–28 path as “a slower, more cautious descent”, put the long-run neutral cluster at 3.0%, and held the 1-year and 3-year windows flat. The local run fetched the projections table directly from federalreserve.gov and read Table 1: the median federal funds rate is **4.1% for end-2026 and 4.1% for end-2027** — the 2027 figure revised up from **3.6%** in June — with a longer-run median of 3.2%, not 3.0%. That is not a slower descent; it is no net easing across all of 2027. A 50bp upward revision to the one-year-out median is specifically information about the one-year window, so it could not be held flat. Five-plus independent outlets lead on the same revision. That single correction is the entire difference between –0.05 and –0.13.
- **One correction to an earlier committed note, logged not edited:** the committed 2026-09-16_draft note says Thune filed the motion to reconsider on the CLARITY cloture vote. It was **Sen. Tillis**, at 3:01pm ET Sept 15, who switched from yes to no expressly so that, as a member of the prevailing side, he could file it (Forbes, CoinDesk, FinanceFeeds, CryptoTimes). Committed sets are never edited, so it is corrected here for the record. No score is affected.
- **Verification:** facts researched with primary-source discipline, corroborated by multiple independent outlets per claim. This cycle's load-bearing fact — the FOMC's 25bp hike and its SEP/dot plot — rests on federalreserve.gov (primary) plus 5+ independent outlets. The 25bp hike itself was ~92.5% priced into market odds beforehand and was NOT used to move P on its own; only the SEP/dot plot's forward guidance, a primary Fed document, moved the score.
- **Known limits, in print inside the reports:** cycle-analog claims rest on 3 completed cycles, a disclosed fragility this report has repeatedly flagged; the TA pillar caps its own conviction at $P = 50 \pm 25$; single-source items are labeled in-line; current chart bars are partial and the completed-bar numbers are printed; the Robustness section shows dropping Iran alone flips the headline to Mild Bull (+0.65), while dropping Tokenization alone pushes it further negative to Mild Bear (–0.60) — the leave-one-out range this cycle (–0.71 to +0.54) genuinely crosses zero.
- **The near-term calendar is still active:** whether the market's next repricing tracks the SEP's projected year-end hike, or fades it · Sen. Kennedy flagged the lame-duck session as the earliest realistic window for a renewed CLARITY attempt · on the Iran pillar, whether the parliamentary NPT-withdrawal bill actually advances, or Pezeshkian's no-nukes line holds.

This is research and education, not financial advice. The scores are probabilistic opinions with dated evidence — built to be argued with. If you check one thing manually, check the Fed & Macro pillar's My Decision section and trigger table — this is the cycle where a meeting this report had been tracking for weeks finally resolved, and you can see exactly how the score moved once the market-priced hike gave way to the SEP's forward guidance.